

GMB Lead Generator

Pricing & Profitability Analysis

Prepared for: JAI MARKETING

Date: June 6, 2026

Exchange Rate: 1 USD = ₹96

Purpose: Full breakdown of Google API costs, plan pricing, billing spike explanation, and profitability after optimisations.

1. Our Plan Pricing

Plan	Price (INR)	Tokens / Leads	Cost Per Lead
Starter	₹3,000	2,400	₹1.25
Growth	₹5,000	5,000	₹1.00
Scale	₹10,000	13,500	₹0.74

Note: 1 token = 1 lead saved. Tokens are deducted only when a lead is written to the database — not per API call or search.

2. Google Places API — How We Are Charged

API Used: Google Places API (New) — places:searchText endpoint

Price per API call: \$0.035 USD = ₹3.36 (at ₹96/USD)

Official pricing page:

<https://mapsplatform.google.com/pricing/>

<https://developers.google.com/maps/documentation/places/web-service/usage-and-billing>

\$200 Free Monthly Credit — Permanent, Not a Trial

Every Google Maps Platform billing account receives **\$200 free credit every month, permanently**. This is completely separate from the GCP new-account trial (\$300 for 90 days). The \$200 Maps credit never expires as long as the billing account is active.

Credit Type	Amount	Duration
GCP New Account Trial	\$300 one-time	90 days only — then gone
Maps Platform Monthly Credit	\$200 every month	Permanent — renews forever

₹ equivalent of free credit: $200 \times ₹96 = ₹19,200$ free every month

API calls covered free: $200 \div \$0.035 = 5,714$ calls per month at zero cost

3. The ₹17,600 Bill — Root Cause Analysis

Old Code — API Calls Per Keyword (Before Fix)

```
1 viewport lookup call
+ 5x5 grid = 25 cells
  × 2 pages per cell (pagination loop)
= 51 API calls per keyword
```

Actual Runs That Caused the Spike (June 1–6, 2026)

Run	Keywords	Calls/KW	Total Calls	Cost (USD)	Cost (INR)
Spain Jewelry	172	51	8,772	\$307.02	₹29,474
India Business	106	51	5,406	\$189.21	₹18,164
Total (both)	278	—	14,178	\$496.23	₹47,638

Free credit applied: −\$200 = −₹19,200

Net Google API charge: \$296.23 = ₹28,438 (actual bill ₹17,600 because earlier June runs had partially consumed the free credit)

Why the Bill 'Exploded' Overnight

The user saw ₹5,000 in the evening when the 172-keyword Spain batch was mid-run. By morning the bill showed ₹17,600 — a ₹12,600 jump overnight. Here is why:

Step	What Happened
1	Earlier June runs consumed most of the \$200 free monthly credit
2	The 172-keyword Spain batch started in the evening (~8,772 API calls)
3	Free credit exhausted — every call charged at ₹3.36 each
4	Run continued overnight — ₹12,600+ added while the user was asleep
5	Morning: bill showed ₹17,600 instead of the ₹5,000 seen at 6 PM

Screenshot Reference — Google Cloud Billing Console (Jun 1–6, 2026):

<https://console.cloud.google.com/billing>

[Attach your Google Cloud billing screenshot here — showing ₹17,600 total for Jun 1–6]

4. New Optimised Code — 80% Cost Reduction

New API Calls Per Keyword (After Fix)

```
1 viewport lookup call
+ 3x3 grid = 9 cells (was 5x5 = 25)
  × 1 page only – pagination removed
= 10 API calls per keyword
```

Search Type	Old Grid	New Grid	Old Calls	New Calls	Savings
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Country (India, Spain)	5×5 = 25 cells	3×3 = 9 cells	51	10	−80%
State / Metro	3×3 = 9 cells	2×2 = 4 cells	19	5	−74%
City / District	2×2 = 4 cells	2×2 = 4 cells	9	5	−44%

Same 278 Keywords With New Code

Run	Keywords	Calls/KW	Total Calls	Cost (USD)	Cost (INR)
Spain Jewelry	172	10	1,720	\$60.20	■5,779
India Business	106	10	1,060	\$37.10	■3,562
Total (both)	278	—	2,780	\$97.30	■9,341

2,780 total calls < 5,714 free calls → Both runs together cost ■0 in Google API fees — fully within free credit

5. Profitability Analysis — Per Plan (Google API Cost Only)

Free Credit Capacity

5,714 free calls ÷ 10 calls per keyword = **571 keywords per month at zero Google API cost**
Any user running fewer than 571 keywords in a month incurs ■0 in Google API fees.

Starter Plan — ■3,000 for 2,400 leads

~30 unique leads per keyword → 80 keywords → 800 API calls → within free tier

Item	Amount
Revenue	■3,000
Google API cost (800 calls — within ■19,200 free credit)	■0
Net Profit (Google API only)	■3,000 (100%)

Growth Plan — ■5,000 for 5,000 leads

167 keywords → 1,670 API calls → within free tier

Item	Amount
Revenue	■5,000
Google API cost (1,670 calls — within free credit)	■0
Net Profit (Google API only)	■5,000 (100%)

Scale Plan — ■10,000 for 13,500 leads

450 keywords → 4,500 API calls → within free tier

Item	Amount
Revenue	■10,000

Google API cost (4,500 calls — within free credit)	■0
Net Profit (Google API only)	■10,000 (100%)

Worst Case — Heavy User Exceeds Free Credit

If a Scale user runs 600+ keywords in one month (very rare):

600 keywords × 10 calls = 6,000 calls

Free credit covers = 5,714 calls

Overage = 286 calls × ■3.36 = ■961 Google API cost

Revenue = ■10,000 → Profit after API cost = ■9,039 (90%)

6. Before vs After — Full Comparison

Metric	Before Fix	After Fix
API calls per keyword	51	10
Google API cost per keyword	■171	■34
Google API cost per lead	■5.70	■0.00 – ■1.12
172-keyword run (Google API cost)	■29,474	■0 (within free credit)
Starter plan (■1.25/lead)	LOSS — ■4.45/lead	PROFIT — ■1.25/lead
Growth plan (■1.00/lead)	LOSS — ■4.70/lead	PROFIT — ■1.00/lead
Scale plan (■0.74/lead)	LOSS — ■4.96/lead	PROFIT — ■0.74/lead

All three plans were losing money on Google API costs before the fix. All three are now fully profitable.

7. Google API Cost Summary

Item	Amount
Price per API call	\$0.035 = ■3.36
Free monthly credit (permanent)	\$200 = ■19,200
Free API calls per month	5,714 calls
Free keywords per month (10 calls each)	571 keywords
Google API cost for typical usage	■0 (within free credit)

As long as monthly usage stays under 5,714 API calls, the Google API cost is ■0.

8. Recommendations

#	Action	Priority
1	Set Google Cloud budget alert at \$150/month Go to: console.cloud.google.com/billing → Budgets & alerts Receive email warning before hitting the \$200 free limit — prevents all future surprise bills.	CRITICAL
2	Keep current plan prices as-is All plans have ■0 Google API cost under normal usage. Do not lower prices.	HIGH
3	Optional: change Scale from 13,500 → 12,000 leads for ■10,000 Raises per-lead rate from ■0.74 to ■0.83 for extra buffer on heavy users.	OPTIONAL
4	Encourage city-level keyword searches City searches use fewer API calls and return denser, more relevant leads. Country-level searches cost 2× more in API calls than city-level.	MEDIUM

9. Key Links & References

Resource	URL
Google Maps Platform Pricing	https://mapsplatform.google.com/pricing/
Places API Billing Documentation	https://developers.google.com/maps/documentation/places/web-service/usage-and-billing
Google Cloud Billing Console	https://console.cloud.google.com/billing
Google Cloud Budget Alerts	https://console.cloud.google.com/billing (→ Budgets & alerts)